[METRIC]
A-A-2892
November 16, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PAD, WRITING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all Federal Agencies.

1.Scope. This description covers writing pads in three sizes.

2. Salient Characteristics.
2.1 Material. The paper shall be white and made from not less than 95% bleached chemical pulp.

2.2 Workmanship. All edges of the paper shall be smoothly and evenly cut. Paper shall be free from holes, tears, wrinkles, dirt, foreign matter, or other defects.

2.3 Physical Requirements of Paper

Table I

Characteristic	Requirement	Tappi Test Method
Basis Weight avg. g/m2 (lbs, 17x22-500) +/- 5%	60 (16)	T410
Bursting strength, kpa avg.,min. (psi)	83 (12)	T807
Thickness, mm, +/- 0.012mm (inch,+/-0.0005 inch)	0.07 (0.0030)	T411
Opacity, percent, min.	75	T425

2.3.1 Writing quality. Paper shall be sufficiently sized to accept fountain pen ink writing without feathering or ink penetration through to the opposite side of the sheet when tested as follows. Draw several lines and characters on both surfaces of the paper with a medium point (commercial type) fountain pen using a one (1) percent aqueous solution of either C.I. Acid Red 1 (Color Index No. 18050) or C.I. Acid Green 3 (Color Index No. 42085). To be considered satisfactory, the lines and characters shall not feather or penetrate through to the opposite side of the paper. Both surfaces of the pad paper shall be sized or otherwise processed to provide good erasability. Good erasability of the paper surface shall be determined as follows. Draw several lines and characters with a No. 2 1/2 lead pencil and erase with a latex rubber eraser; on the same area, redraw pencil lines or characters and erase. The tested area shall not show smearing of the pencil lines, or failure of the paper fiber.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza New York, N.Y. 10278.

FSC 7530

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2.3.2 Color. The pad sheets shall be white, and all the same color.

2.4 Backing. The pad backing shall be chipboard or other suitable paperboard which shall conform to Table II.

Table II

Characteristic	Requirement	Tappi Test Method
Thickness, min.,mm (inch)	0.48 (0.020)	T411
Bursting strength, avg.min. kpa (psi)	345 (50)	T807

2.5 Size. The pads shall be 7.6 X 12.7 cm (3x5 inch), 12.7 x 20.3 cm (5x8 inch), or 21.6 x 27.9 cm (8 1/2 x 11 inch) as specified in the ordering data. A tolerance of +/-0.3 cm (+/- 1/8 inch) in each direction shall be permitted. The first dimension given is the horizontal dimension.

2.6 Rulings. The sheets shall be ruled or unruled, as specified. Sizes 7.6 x 12.7 cm (3x5 inch) and 12.7 x 20.3 cm (5x8 inch) shall be unruled. Size 21.6 x 27.9 cm (8 1/2x11 inch) shall be unruled, ruled one side or ruled two sides, as specified in the ordering data.

When specified, rulings shall conform to the following spacings:
For 21.6 x 27.9 cm (8 1/2x11 inch) pads: Lines shall be spaced 0.8 cm (5/16 inch) apart with a tolerance of +/- 0.1 cm (+/- 1/16 inch). The first line shall begin 3.5 cm (1 3/8 inch), plus 0.4 cm (3/16 inch) or minus 0.3 cm (1/8 inch), from top edge of the paper. The unlined portion of the front and back sides of the sheet shall be located at the binding end of the sheet.

2.7 Ink. The ruling ink shall be blue color, continuous and uniform without waviness or feathering of the lines.

2.8 Assembly of pads. Not less than one hundred sheets of paper and a backing sheet of equal size, +/- 0.1 cm (+/- 1/16inch) shall be securely fastened together along the top edge (horizontal dimension). Pads shall be fastened with a hot melt plastic resin material, or a cold water resistant, padding compound material, or an adhesive binding material with cheesecloth strip, at the option of the contractor, unless otherwise specified. Pads ruled on one side only shall be assembled with the ruled side uppermost.

2.8.1 Punching. When required, shall be punched as specified in the ordering data.

2.9 Padding strength. Hold the pad to be tested in a stationary, vertical position with the padded edge down. While holding the backing, allow the sheet pad to naturally fall until it hangs supported by the padding. While performing this test, do not twist or jerk the backing. Repeat the test three additional times. The pads of sheets shall not become detached from the pad backing nor separated for more than one inch along the padded edge.

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2.10 Binding quality and strength. Remove five (5) sheets, one sheet at a time, from the pad. Examine the torn edge of the sheets. The edge shall not be ripped with ragged edges but shall have a clean and straight edge. Sheets shall be able to be removed with reasonable effort. Fold at least five (5) sheets over and under the pad and press the fold slightly. Examine the sheets and binding at the fold. The sheets shall not break, split, or separate from the binding of the pad.

3. Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data, the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, hypochlorite, or other chlorine containing compound. Certification of compliance shall be made available upon request by the Government.

4. Regulatory Requirements. The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials including 20% postconsumer materials in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (b), dated October 20, 1993 (See definition of postconsumer materials and recovered materials in sections 203 and 205). As an alternative to meeting the standards of section 504(b) for all printing and writing papers, the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials that are a waste material byproduct of a finished product other than a paper or textile product which would otherwise be disposed of in a landfill, as determined by the State in which the facility is located, in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (c), dated October 20, 1993. The pad backing offered shall include a minimum of 90% postconsumer recovered materials, in accordance with CFR 40 Part 250. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.1 Labeling. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

5. Quality Assurance Provisions.
5.1 Inspection.
5.1.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.1.2 Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all the inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the contractor may utilize his own facilities or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the plans specified in Table III, unless otherwise stated. For the purposes of sampling for end item testing, a lot shall consist of pads submitted for inspection at one time. Unless otherwise specified, the sample unit shall be one pad. Unless otherwise specified, every lot shall be tested. There shall be no failures to meet requirements.

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Table III

Examine	Inspection Level	AQL (% defect)/ acceptance
Workmanship/general	S-3	4.0
Dimensions/assembly	S-4	2.5
Physical Requirements	S-2 (1)	2.5 (1)

(1) Tappi tests shall be in accordance with Tappi T400 for the applicable Tappi test methods.

6. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Packaging, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. Applicable Documents and Document Sources. The following documents form a part of the Commercial Item Description to the extent specifiec herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:
(1) Tappi Standards are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.
(2) MIL-STD-105 is available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.
(3) Executive Order 12873 is available from The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building, White House, Att: Publications, Washington, D.C. 20500. Phone (202) 395-7332.
(4) The Code of Federal Regulations, Title 40, Protection of Environment, Part 250 may be purchased from the Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402. Phone (202)783-3238. When ordering, ask for: Title 40, Parts 190-250; Stock Number: 869-013-00-146-0.
(5) Copies of Commercial Item Descriptions, federal standards or specifications are available from: Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specification Section (3FPB-W), Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.

8. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:
1. Title, number and date of the Commercial Item Description
2. Size
3. Ruled or unruled
4. Punching, if required
5. If non-chlorine bleaching is required
6. Packaging, packing and marking

MILITARY INTEREST:

NONE: DOD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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